

Seam curves round over the shoulder blades

Additional layers of padding protect the back, shoulders, chest, and upper arms

Narrow cuff

25 buttons on each sleeve

Each hose leg is made from a single piece of fabric cut on the bias (diagonal)

Tight-fitting hose were more suitable for posing than bending and working



IN DETAIL



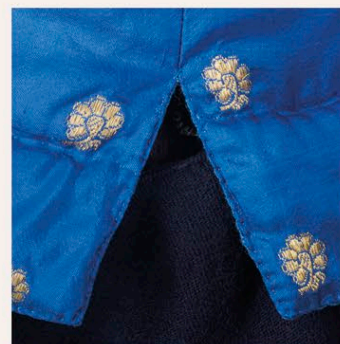
◀ TAILORING

A close view of the back curve of the armhole shows the gussets that create the *grande assiette* – the large plate shape that defines the armhole. Each sleeve has nine pattern pieces. The many pieces economically use up every scrap of the highly expensive fabric.



◀ FLATTENED BUTTONS

The doublet's 50 sleeve buttons and 30 buttons at the front opening are made from a circle of silk stuffed with cotton wool and sewn into a tight, firm ball. Towards the waist, flatter buttons with a wooden or bone interior allow a belt to be worn comfortably.



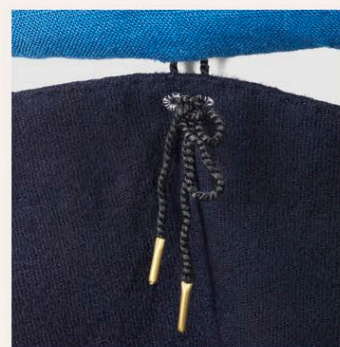
◀ SLASHED VENTS

Slashes at each side seam at the same level as the points (where the hose are attached) help the wearer to move freely.



◀ LINING AND CUFFS

The lining of the doublet is fine blue linen, which is laid over with a thin layer of cotton wool and then a layer of silk. The garment is then quilted through all the layers. Buttonholes are stitched with silk thread.



◀ SUSPENDED HOSE

The hose are suspended from the doublet by five pairs of laces with metal aglets or chapes. These are sewn into the doublet and threaded through eyelets on the hose. Later garments had eyelets on the doublet too.